roam

the reels you share, pinned to a map you build together.

TEAM ROAM

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Short-form video is now the new word-of-mouth — and no one has built the infrastructure for it.

Before social media, people found restaurants via Zagat or a friend's recommendation. Then Yelp digitized reviews. Then Instagram made photos the discovery layer. Now TikTok and Reels have replaced both — but no one has built the save-and-act layer that makes this behavior productive.

5–15+

reels/week shared about places (user interviews)

0%

of those become an actual visit

#1

reason: saved content becomes invisible noise

THE PROBLEM

The discovery-to-action gap has never been wider.

Gen Z shares reels of restaurants, bars, and experiences constantly. The intent is real — these are places they genuinely want to visit. But the tools available to save and act on that intent are fragmented, manual, and built for a different era of discovery.

THE CURRENT WORKAROUND:

1. Screenshot the reel — no location data attached.
2. Drop a note in Notes or Notion — no structure, piles up.
3. Star it on Google Maps — if you can even find which place.
4. *Get free time to go out — can't remember what you saved.*

Three forces converging make this the right moment.

01

Video is the default discovery layer

Short-form video has replaced Yelp, Google Maps, and word-of-mouth for Gen Z place discovery. This is a durable shift — the behavior will only grow as the demographic ages into more purchasing power.

02

Multimodal AI makes real-time extraction viable

18 months ago, parsing a reel for location data was too slow and error-prone to build a product around. Today, models can extract place candidates from frames, captions, and overlays in under 3 seconds.

03

Social maps are a proven consumer behavior

BeReal, Snap Map, and Google's collaborative lists have normalized sharing your location layer with friends. Roam builds on top of this habit rather than trying to create it.

THE SOLUTION

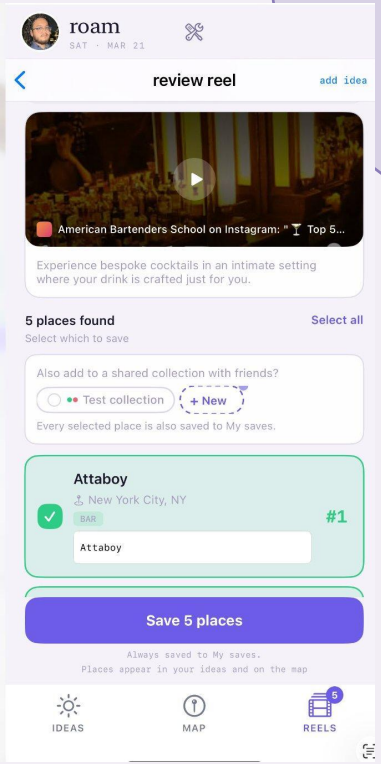
Share the reel.
We do the rest.

1. **Share**
   Tap share → Roam from Instagram or TikTok.

2. **Extract**
   AI reads the frames, captions, and metadata.

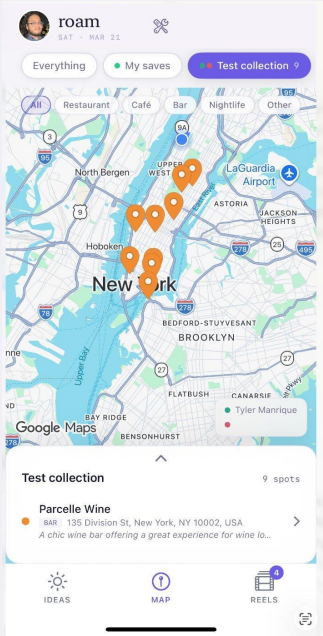
3. **Resolve**
   Each candidate matches to a real Google place.

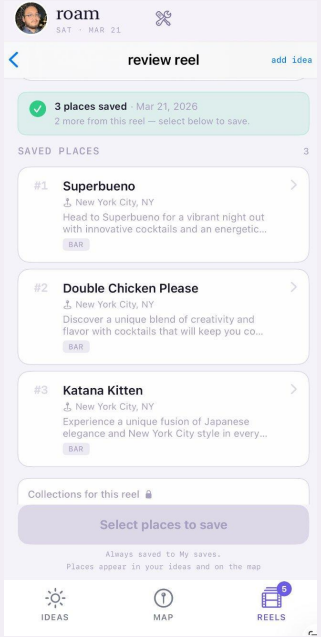
4. **Pin**
   One tap saves it to your map and your friends'.



AI extracted 5 bars from one reel

A working MVP. In production, on iOS, today.





REEL → MAP PIPELINE

Share sheet, AI extraction, candidate review, location override — all live.

SHARED COLLECTIONS

Personal map plus collections you build with friends. Each contributor color-coded.

ALSO BUILT, FLAGGED OFF

Full event coordination — invites, RSVPs, calendar — hidden behind a feature flag.

WHAT WE'VE BUILT

A working MVP. In production, on iOS, today.

Roam is not a prototype. The reel ingestion pipeline, AI extraction, Google Places resolution, and shared collection layer are all live and functional.

REEL-TO-MAP PIPELINE (LIVE)

Share sheet integration with Instagram and TikTok, multimodal AI extraction, candidate review UI, and location override — all working end-to-end in production.

SHARED COLLECTIONS (LIVE)

Users can maintain a personal map and join collections with friends. Each contributor is color-coded on the map so you can see whose recommendation a pin came from.

EVENT COORDINATION (BUILT, FLAGGED OFF)

A full conversational planning experience — invites, RSVPs, calendar integration, and a group itinerary builder. Fully built and tested. Currently hidden behind a feature flag.

COMPETITION

No one owns the reel-to-place layer — yet.

The competitive landscape consists of tools that partially address the problem but miss the core behavior: turning a shared reel into a pinned, actionable location on a social map.

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT FAILS	OUR ADVANTAGE
Google Maps	Save + star places	*Can't parse video; no reel layer*	We ingest the reel, not just the pin
Instagram Saves	Save reels to collections	*No location extraction or map view*	We extract and geo-resolve the place
TikTok Notes	Bookmark reels for later	*Lives inside one app; no planning*	We work across platforms
Notion / Notes	Manual screenshot + link dump	*Completely manual; doesn't scale*	Zero friction — one tap
Roam	Reel → AI → shared pin	—	**All of the above**

WHERE WE ACTUALLY ARE

Honest state of the company.

We are pre-traction. The product is built and in App Store review. Here is an honest read of where we stand:

SIGNAL

- MVP shipped to iOS (awaiting App Store review)
- Reel-to-pin pipeline works end-to-end in production
- Every person who has tried it calls it "cool"
- Shared collections feel intuitive — no onboarding needed

NOISE

- No strong pull, no one asking for access yet
- Usage data is messy (pre-launch conditions)
- No clear ICP — three hypotheses, none validated
- Feature flag hides work that may confuse the story

HOW WE'LL KNOW IT'S WORKING

Three metrics. Three segment hypotheses. Measured manually.

We are not chasing vanity metrics. The plan: manually recruit 10–15 users per segment, observe them in context, and measure the three retention signals that indicate genuine pull.

30%

DAY 1 RETENTION

Target within a single test segment. Baseline for first-session stickiness.

15%

DAY 7 RETENTION

The bar for true repeat behavior — people coming back unprompted.

10–15

USERS PER SEGMENT

Manually recruited and observed. Qualitative context + behavioral data.

THREE SEGMENT HYPOTHESES WE'RE TESTING

aesthetic map curators · travel planners · urban explorers (NYC-first)

EVENTS WE'RE INSTRUMENTING: create_pin · save_location · return_session (D1, D7) · share_map · reel_ingested

Freemium with a premium social layer.

The free tier makes Roam's value obvious and viral — users share maps with friends who don't yet have the app, creating organic acquisition. Pro and Group tiers capture users who depend on Roam heavily enough to pay.

Free

$0

Always free

- Up to 10 reels/month processed
- Personal map
- 1 shared collection
- Standard AI extraction speed

Pro

$6/mo

Most popular

- Unlimited reels
- Unlimited shared collections
- Priority AI extraction (< 2s)
- Early access to new features

Group

$3/person/mo

3+ members

- Everything in Pro
- Group trip planning UI
- Event coordination (invites, RSVPs)
- Shared itinerary builder

A large market, sized from the bottom up.

We start with the behavior we can observe, not with a top-down TAM fabrication. The market is US-first, Gen Z-first, and urban-first.

TAM	**~70M**	US Gen Z + Millennial active social media users who discover places via short-form video
SAM	**~21M**	~30% who actively save place-content and express intent to visit (observed behavior in user interviews)
SOM	**~210K**	Urban early adopters, 18–26, discovery-driven — Year 1 beachhead (1% of SAM)

At $6/mo Pro × 1% SAM conversion = $15M ARR. Group tier adds upside. Achievable at 5-year horizon with disciplined ICP targeting.

THE TEAM

Five builders who live the problem.

Every member of Team Roam is a Gen Z user who has felt the frustration of losing a reel to the void. We are not building for a demographic — we are building for ourselves.

AA

Arleen Alcaraz-Cano

Product & Design

DN

Diya Nair

Strategy & Development

DD

Daniel David

Engineering

TM

Tyler Manrique

Engineering

SO

Stanley Omondi

Growth & Operations

Three hypotheses. One will be right.

A

Aesthetic Map Curators

Who: 18–24, heavy Instagram/TikTok users. Build curated lists not just to visit but to share and flex.

Pain: Wants a beautiful, shareable map that doubles as a social object. Notes app doesn't cut it.

Signal to watch: Will they share their Roam map publicly?

B

Travel Planners

Who: 22–30, planning trips 2–6x/year. Active research phase: saving content months in advance.

Pain: Context collapses between discovery and the trip — can't remember why a place was saved.

Signal to watch: Will they use Roam in pre-trip research and return with friends?

C

Urban Explorers (NYC-first)

Who: 19–26, NYC locals, eat out or go out 3–5x/week. Reels are a constant discovery stream.

Pain: Saved reels pile up. Going out tonight requires a 10-minute dig through old screenshots.

Signal to watch: Will they open Roam when deciding where to go tonight?

We built a full event planner. It's flagged off.

Early in development, we built an entire conversational planning experience — a chatbot-style interface that lets groups plan outings together: set dates, send invites, track RSVPs, and sync to calendar. It is fully functional and tested. We made a deliberate decision to hide it.

THE ARGUMENT FOR KEEPING IT HIDDEN:

- Complicates the core narrative — the reel-to-pin story is simpler and more powerful.
- May attract users who want a planner, not a discovery tool — wrong ICP.
- Adds surface area to support before we know what the real product is.

THE ARGUMENT FOR SHIPPING IT:

It completes the loop: discover → save → go. Without it, Roam is a wishlist. With it, it's a coordination layer — potentially stickier and more defensible.

WHAT WE WANT FROM YOU

Please give us feedback!

We are at the most uncertain point in the company's life — we have a working product and no validated pull. The most valuable thing you can give us is an honest answer to these three questions:

01

Which segment would YOU bet on?

Aesthetic curators, travel planners, or urban explorers — which would you actually use, which is dead on arrival? Be brutal.

02

How should we monetize this?

Freemium with a reel cap? Premium shared collections? Group pricing? What feels right — and what would make you bounce immediately?

03

Plans + chatbot — kill, hide, or ship?

We built a full conversational planning experience. It's flagged off. Does it complete the product or does it kill the story?